MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 8/21/2024

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
July 17, 2024

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Samantha Pitchford, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon (arrived at 9:05 am)

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the agenda, **motion carried**.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of June 12, 2024, **motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Kim Kennecott requested the Board of Commissioners pass a resolution agreeing to fund the Clare County Airport.

Mick Haley announced that he is running for County Commissioner 6th District and gave overview of experience.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Notice of Master Plan, City of Harrison – No discussion
2. Letter from Jaynie Hoerauf – No discussion
3. Resolution Opposing MDHHS Plans to Implement New Conflict Free Access and Planning Strategies in Michigan, Eaton County – No discussion
4. Resolution Opposing the FY25 Governor's Recommended Budget Reducing Operational Funding for the Michigan Conservation Districts, Crawford County – No discussion
5. Resolution Designating the Month of June Pride Month, Genesee County – No discussion

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Clerk-Election Reporting Discussion
   Clerk Lori Mott explained to the Board of Commissioners that she ordered an election night reporting software in January and the vendor promptly went to work to ensure the software would be ready for the February Election. In late February the vendor sent a contract to be signed. Clerk Mott did not use the software in February because the contract needed to be approved by the Board of Commissioners. When presented to the Board of Commissioners in March of 2024 there was a tie vote, which results in a failed motion.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

1. Clerk-Election Reporting Discussion - continued
   Clerk Mott did not think any more about the software until June of 2024 when she received a bill for the set-up of the software. Clerk Mott apologized for the error and not realizing there was a contract and asked the Board of Commissioners to reconsider the motion.

   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, Seconded by Commissioner Majewski to reconsider motion to approve the purchase of election reporting software in the amount of $5,000.00 and yearly licensing fee of $1,500.00 for a total this year of $6,500.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Majewski, Pitchford, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis and Haskell
   Nays: (1) being Commissioner Gilmore
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, Seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the election reporting software contract, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Housler, Hoefling, Kleinhardt, Pitchford, Fancon, Majewski and Haskell
   Nays: (1) being Commissioner Gilmore
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Patrick Tedham, Advantage Benefits Group
   Mr. Tedham was not present, Mr. Mike Cutlip from Advantage Benefits Group gave a presentation on the Advantage Benefits Group and the benefits and cost savings with the different plans being offered.

2. Commissioner Ambrozaitis – Airport Presentation
   Commissioner Ambrozaitis gave a presentation of the Clare County Airport and discussed some of the items the Airport Committee has been able to accomplish in 2024, which included new updated leases for the restaurant and hangers. Commissioner Ambrozaitis outlined the short range plan – fixing cracked runways, removing gravel from runway C and finish existing airport terminal. The Airport Committee and pilots are trying to put together events and fundraisers to raise money and bring in more airport traffic. Commissioner Ambrozaitis invited everyone to visit the new website for the airport – www.harrisonapa.org

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps confirmed she is working on contract negotiations with 6 of the 9 union units and the 2025 budget. Administrator Phelps gave an update regarding funding for counties included in the Governor's Budget. She then reported that out of 14 counties, 7 SPARKS Grants were awarded, 3 of those awards being to Clare County with Hayes Township receiving $722,500.00, Lincoln Township received $772,700.00 and the City of Harrison for $757,700.00. Administrator Phelps applauded Hayes Township, Lincoln Township and the City of Harrison on their hard work in obtaining these competitive grants.

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps reported that the expenditures are at 72.4%, which is about the same as last year.

Recess at 10:10 a.m.
Back in Session at 10:15 a.m.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Gilmore to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of July 8, 2024 in the amount of $250,764.87 and the meeting minutes of June 24, 2024 in the amount of $43,984.09, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Housler, Gilmore, Pitchford, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Majewski and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the expenditures for the month of June in the amount of $2,747,900.48 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,069,464.96, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Majewski, Housler, Gilmore, Pitchford, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Pitchford, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve budget adjustments of 24-104 and 24-105 in the amounts of $93,652.53 and $163,266.72, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Pitchford, Majewski, Hoefling, Housler, Gilmore, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

4. Sale of Property
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve sale of Redding Township Property in the amount of $30,000.00, roll call revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Hoefling, Pitchford, Housler, Gilmore, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott had no report.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners and reported that the first 2024 land sale will be on August 1, 2024 and will include 28 properties. Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger reported that the 2024 property tax bills have been mailed out along with the delinquent tax notices and confirmed that Board of Review has been completed.

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger confirmed that she worked into the evening hours the night before with the Clerk performing the 6-hour long Public Accuracy Test on the election equipment, program cards and ballots that will be used in the Clare County Early Voting in August.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman Jeff Haskell reported that the Clare County unemployment rate is 5.7% and reminded everyone that the Harrison Street Fair is in August.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Dale Majewski has been attending his meetings and spoke about the Sparks Grant awarded to Lincoln Township in the amount of $772,700.00. Commissioner Majewski also confirmed that the tornado that touched down over the July 4th weekend was rated EF1 and most of the damage was east of Old State Road.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler attended her meetings.

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a summary of the meetings he attends.

Commissioner Pitchford reminded everyone about the Farwell Lumberjack Festival.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis had no report.

Commissioner Gilmore had no report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt commented on the ballot proposals from the State regarding local control that didn't get enough signatures.

Commissioner Fancon had no report.

PUBLIC COMMENT

None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

Meeting Adjourned at 10:58 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

Jeff Haskell, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners